Recruitment and Selection Policy

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Recruitment and Selection Policy

Policy Title: Recruitment and Selection Policy

Effective Date: 2025-09-26

Review Date: 01/2026

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Applies to: All staff involved in the recruitment of employees at test

1. Policy Statement

At test, we are committed to recruiting staff who are competent, caring, and suitable to work with vulnerable adults. We will follow robust, transparent, and fair recruitment processes to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory standards and to protect our residents from harm. We are fully committed to promoting equality, diversity, and inclusion throughout our recruitment practices and ensuring that all appointments are made based on merit.

2. Legal Framework

This policy adheres to:

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- Regulation 19: Fit and Proper Persons Employed
- CQC Fundamental Standards
- The Equality Act 2010
- Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 (Exceptions Order 1975)
- Data Protection Act 2018 / UK GDPR

3. Aims of the Policy

- To ensure only individuals who are suitable and fit to work in care are employed
- To follow safer recruitment practices and safeguard residents
- To conduct a fair, consistent, and non-discriminatory selection process
- To meet all regulatory and legal requirements related to employment

4. Scope

This policy applies to all internal and external applicants for roles at test, including:

- Permanent and temporary staff
- Volunteers
- Contractors and agency workers
- Students and apprentices

5. Responsibilities

Registered Manager / Recruitment Lead:

- Oversees the recruitment process
- Ensures pre-employment checks are completed before start date
- Maintains accurate recruitment records

Interview Panel Members:

- Apply fair and consistent interview practices
- Comply with confidentiality and equality obligations

6. Recruitment Process

6.1 Vacancy Identification and Approval

- All vacancies must be approved by management
- Job descriptions and person specifications must be reviewed and updated

6.2 Advertising

- Jobs will be advertised internally and externally
- All adverts must include a commitment to safeguarding and equal opportunities

6.3 Application and Shortlisting

- Applicants must complete an application form or submit a CV with equal opportunities monitoring
- Shortlisting will be based solely on skills, experience, and qualifications relevant to the role

6.4 Interview

- All interviews will be conducted by at least two staff members
- Structured interview questions will assess suitability, values, and safeguarding awareness
- Notes will be recorded and stored securely

6.5 Conditional Offer

A conditional offer will be made subject to satisfactory completion of:

- Enhanced Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check with Adult Barred List
- Two written references (one must be from most recent employer)
- Proof of identity and right to work in the UK
- Verification of qualifications and training
- Full employment history, with any gaps explained

- Health declaration / Occupational health clearance, if required

7. Safer Recruitment and Safeguarding

We follow safer recruitment practices to ensure that staff do not pose a risk to residents. These include:

- Ensuring all offers are conditional pending checks
- Not permitting unsupervised access to residents until all checks are completed
- Reporting any safeguarding concerns about applicants or references to appropriate authorities

8. Recruitment of Ex-Offenders

Having a criminal conviction will not necessarily bar someone from working with us. Decisions will be made based on:

- The nature of the offence
- Its relevance to the role
- The time since the offence
- Evidence of rehabilitation

All applicants must declare any convictions that are not “spent” under the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974, or are listed as exempt due to working with vulnerable adults.

9. Record Keeping

- All recruitment documentation will be kept securely in line with data protection legislation
- A single central recruitment record will be maintained
- Recruitment audits may be carried out to ensure compliance

10. Induction and Probation

- All new staff will receive a structured induction including safeguarding, infection control, and policies
- A probation period of [e.g., 3 or 6 months] will apply
- Performance will be reviewed regularly, and employment confirmed upon successful completion

11. Monitoring and Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or in response to legislative or regulatory changes. Recruitment data may be monitored to improve practices and support equality.

12. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Equality, Diversity & Human Rights Policy

- Whistleblowing Policy
- Staff Supervision and Appraisal Policy
- Data Protection and Confidentiality Policy
- Disciplinary and Grievance Policy

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